

Introduction

Gold (Chemical Symbol-Au) is primarily a monetary asset and partly a commodity.

Gold is the world's oldest international currency.

Gold is an important element of global monetary reserves.

With regard to the investment value, more than two-thirds of gold total accumulated holdings is with central banks' reserves, private players, and held in the form of jeweler.

Less than one-third of gold's total accumulated holdings are used as “commodity” for jewelers in the western markets and industry.

Demand and Supply

World investment amounted to 1614 MT in 2012, broadly flat year-on-year, but the approximate value of this demand reached a new record of almost \$87 billion.